

Pregnancy - Urination Pain - Female (Adult)

Algorithm 1367 | Adult (18 years and older) | Gender at birth: Female

Definition

- UAT-only assessment of painful urination or suspected urinary infection in a confirmed current pregnancy; not approved for real-patient or production use.
- Adult patient.
- Female.

Initial assessment

1. [YES_NO] Is the patient currently pregnant, and has the pregnancy been confirmed?
2. [OPEN_TEXT] How old is the patient and how many weeks pregnant are they?
3. [YES_NO] Can the patient speak privately and safely? If under 18, assess coercion, abuse, exploitation, and whether the accompanying adult may be unsafe under the Qatar safeguarding pathway approved for UAT.
4. [TEMPERATURE] What is the temperature, if measured, and are there chills or shaking?
5. [YES_NO] Is there back or flank pain, vomiting, contractions, vaginal bleeding, fluid loss, or reduced or changed fetal movement?

Triage and redirect questions

1. Redirect → Flank Pain

Is pain in the side or back the main concern rather than pain primarily during urination?

Pain focused in the side or back belongs in the Flank Pain pathway.

1. Disposition level 100

Along with urinary symptoms, is the patient confused, difficult to wake, severely short of breath, fainting or collapsing, unable to keep fluids down and rapidly worsening, having regular contractions or fluid loss, bleeding heavily, or reporting reduced or changed fetal movement?

Sepsis red flags or signs of preterm labor in a pregnant person with a possible urinary tract infection require immediate emergency care.

1. Disposition level 70

In this confirmed pregnancy, is there painful or frequent urination, urgency, blood in the urine, fever or chills, or back or flank pain without the emergency features above?

NHS.UK cystitis guidance lists pregnancy itself as an automatic urgent-review criterion, since untreated UTIs in pregnancy carry a higher risk of kidney infection and preterm labor.

Advice

Emergency pregnancy urinary symptom precautions

- For a life-threatening emergency, call Qatar 999. Otherwise go immediately to the emergency department at the patient's booked HMC maternity hospital or the Qatar maternity destination approved for this UAT environment. Do not drive if faint, confused, severely unwell, or bleeding heavily. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.
- Call Back If: worsening contractions or fluid loss; heavier bleeding; confusion, collapse, or breathing difficulty.

Same-day pregnancy urinary assessment

- Arrange same-day in-person maternity or obstetric assessment through the patient's booked service or the Qatar pathway approved for this UAT environment. A urine test and clinical assessment may be required. Do not use leftover antibiotics or start an antibiotic, urinary remedy, or pain medicine unless a maternity clinician or pharmacist confirms it is appropriate in this pregnancy.
- Call Back If: fever or vomiting develops; back or flank pain worsens; contractions, bleeding, fluid loss, or changed fetal movement develops.

First aid

- For a life-threatening emergency, call Qatar 999. Otherwise go immediately to the emergency department at the patient's booked HMC maternity hospital or the Qatar maternity destination approved for this UAT environment. Do not drive if faint, confused, severely unwell, or bleeding heavily. Call Qatar 999 now, follow the call-taker's ambulance and emergency-transport instructions, and do not self-drive. Do not delay emergency care.

References

- NHS.UK, "Cystitis", <https://www.nhs.uk/conditions/cystitis/> (page last reviewed 11 July 2025) - pregnancy-specific urgent-review criterion
- NICE, "Pyelonephritis (acute): antimicrobial prescribing", NG111, <https://www.nice.org.uk/guidance/ng111/chapter/recommendations>
- Hamad Medical Corporation, "Maternity Care", <https://hamad.qa/EN/Hospitals-and-services/WWRC/Our-Services/Pages/Maternity-Care.aspx> (accessed 25 July 2026)
- World Health Organization, "Assessing and supporting adolescents' capacity for autonomous decision-making in health care settings", 2021

Provenance

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